The Torma for All Bhūtas

Bali Sarvabhūta · Toh 1241 · Derge Tengyur
འབྱུང་པོ་ཐམས་ཅད་ཀྱི་གཏོར་མ

The Torma for All Bhūtas, known in Sanskrit as Bali Sarvabhūta and in Tibetan as Jungpo Tamché kyi Torma, is a short ritual manual belonging to the Hevajra cycle of tantric practice. Opening with homage to Hevajra and Vajrasattva, it sets out a rite for offering a torma, a ritual cake, in order to protect beings from obstructing spirits and misleaders. The practitioner visualizes a three-tiered lotus bearing the eight great gods, the eight protectors of the directions and the eight great nāgas, gathers all classes of beings into them, prepares and blesses the offering with mantras, and finally requests the guests to depart, with the promise that the rite brings protection, harmony and success in the various ritual activities. Attributed in its colophon to the master Ajitacandra and translated by the Indian preceptor Gayādhara with the Tibetan translator Shākya Yeshé, it is Toh 1241 in the Tengyur, where it is placed among the commentaries and ritual works on the tantras.

In the language of India: ba liṃ sarba bhū ta. In the language of Tibet: The Torma for All Bhūtas.

Homage to glorious Hevajra.

Having paid homage to Vajrasattva,
who has entered the certainty of e vaṃ,
I compose this torma rite to protect sentient beings
from obstructors, vināyakas and the like.

The yogin endowed with the union of Hevajra
should meditate as follows.
Within the source of phenomena,
on a three-tiered lotus of eight petals,
white, black and red, from oṃ āḥ hūṃ,
in order, the eight great gods,
the eight protectors of the directions and the eight great nāgas
are to be generated, each in the color of its lotus.

In the east generate Maheśvara (Śiva);
in the south one should visualize Indra;
in the west generate Brahmā;

and in the north, Viṣṇu.
In the southeast generate Kāmeśvara, the Lord of Desire;
in the southwest, the Lord of the Quarter;
Bhṛṅgiriṭi in the northwest;
and in the northeast, the youth Kārttika.

On the eastern petal visualize Śakra (Indra);
in the south one should place Antaka, the Ender;
the Lord of the Waters is on the western petal;
likewise in the north place the yakṣa.
In the fire quarter, the southeast, is the Great Fire;
in the quarter of Nairṛti, the rākṣasa;
in the northwest corner, Vāyu, god of the wind;
and in the northeast, the lord of the bhūtas.

Karkoṭa, and Śaṅkhapāla,
Ananta, and likewise Vāsuki,
Takṣaka, and Kulika,
Mahāpadma, and the Most Excellent Lotus.

All of them have one face and two hands,
holding a vajra and a bell in their hands.
Consorts of their own color embrace their limbs.
They sit on their seats with the right leg extended.

From the seed syllable in one's own heart
light rays stream forth like hooks,
and into the eight gods are gathered
the gods of the form realm and of the formless realm.
The gods and humans of the desire realm
are gathered fully into the eight protectors of the directions.
The three lower realms and the asuras
are to be gathered into the eight great nāgas.

In order to invite the maṇḍala
that abides in the natural state,
Gaurī draws it in,
Caurī binds it with the noose,
Vetālī fetters it with the chain,
and Ghasmarī intoxicates it with the bell.

From the heart of the yogin
light rays stream forth like hooks,
summoning the Victors of the ten directions together with their heirs.
Worship them with outer, inner and secret offerings.
At the end of their conferral of empowerment,
each is crowned by the lord of its own family:
the eight great gods by Śāśvata,
the eight protectors of the directions by Vajra,
and the eight nāgas by Narteśvara, the Lord of Dance.

Then prepare the torma according to the rite.
Upon the maṇḍalas of wind and fire,
imagine a lotus vessel arisen from a.
In it are bhrūṃ āṃ jṝṃ khaṃ hūṃ;
from them come go ku da ha na,
the five buddhas and the five beings.
Imagine them in the midst of moon and sun.
In the middle of the sun imagine hūṃ, which becomes a vajra;
by its blazing and its radiating,
the nectar is to be fully accomplished.
Having meditated on this as having the nature of water,
bless it with oṃ āḥ hūṃ and offer it.

The mantra for offering the torma to them is this: oṃ andi ja ma ja la jakkha bhū ta bahni bā u rakkha canda sujja mā da pāppa ta la pā tā le aṣṭa sappa svā hā. That is for the guests of the torma.

i daṃ bi laṃ bhuñja jiṃ gha phulla dhūppa māṃ sa pi ghaṃ. That is the request to partake.

aṃ bha sappa kajja sā da khānti khu ṇi phe ḍa gā da. That is the petition.

oṃ a kā ro mu khaṃ sarba dharmā ṇāṃ ā dya nutpa nna tvāt oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svā hā. This is the blessing.

Then, having pleased them, one should recite the hundred syllables to request them to depart: oṃ bajra satva sa ma ya ma nu pā la ya bajra satva tve no ba tiṣṭha dṛ ḍho me bha ba su to ṣyo me bha ba a nu rakto me bha ba su po ṣyo me bha ba sarba sidhi mme pra ya ccha sarbba karmma su ca me ci ttaṃ śre yaḥ ku ru hūṃ ha ha ha ha hoḥ bha ga vān sarbba ta thā ga ta bajra mā me muñca bajri bha ba ma hā sa ma ya satva āḥ muḥ

If one gives this torma and makes offerings fully, all the bhūtas will act favorably toward the yogin. Throughout his life there will be happiness free of disturbance, the gods will be pleased, and his retinue will act favorably. If one gives torma to this host of bhūtas, it will accomplish subjugation, fierce rites, the destruction of enemy armies, expulsion, summoning, pacification, happiness and increase.

This completes the Rite of the Torma for All Bhūtas composed by the master Ajitacandra. It was translated by the Indian preceptor Gayādhara and the translator, the monk Shākya Yeshé.

Translator's Notes

- "The Lord of the Quarter" (southwest) renders the Tibetan as written; in parallel lists of the eight great gods this slot is often Gaṇapati, which would be "lord of hosts," so the reading may be a copyist's variant. The eighth nāga is literally "the Most Excellent Lotus"; the usual list has Padma here, but the name is kept as the Tibetan gives it. Śāśvata ("the Eternal"), Vajra and Narteśvara are Hevajra-cycle names of the family lords (commonly identified with Vairocana, Akṣobhya and Amitābha). In the closing list of rites, the word otherwise rendered "empowerment" denotes the rite of subjugation (vaśya). The syllable before "torma" after the hundred-syllable mantra is evidently a slip for the ordinary spelling of torma and is read so.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.